

Clermont County Township Association Regular Meeting Minutes

Date: 05/15/2025

Host: Goshen Township

Meeting was called to order: Meeting called to order by Bob Hausermann at 6:41 PM with the following CCTA Officers & Active Members in attendance:

Goshen Township:

Trustee / CCTA President Bob Hausermann, Trustees Lisa Allen, Dan Hodges

Ohio Township:

Trustee Rick Hinson

Pierce Township:

Trustee / CCTA Vice President Allen Freeman

Tate Township:

Fiscal Officer Kathy Brannock

Union Township:

Trustee John Becker

Wayne Township:

Trustee Teresa Hinnners

Williamsburg Township:

Trustee Guy Bainum

And CCTA Secretary/Treasurer Shelby Baird

Mr. Hausermann introduced Lisa Allen, who thanked everyone for attending. Mr. Hausermann proceeded with a quick run-down of the meeting's agenda and moved on to CCTA business.

CCTA Business:

Treasurer: Mr. Baird reviewed the March and April 2025 Treasurer's reports. The total cash on hand for the CCTA remains at \$3,521.55. Mr. Bainum moved to approve the reports as read, seconded by Mr. Hinson. Motion carried.

Secretary: Mr. Baird proceeded to review the minutes for the February and March regular meetings and the April 7 special meeting. Mr. Hausermann asked if the members present had reviewed the minutes and if there were calls for any corrections. No calls for omissions or corrections were made. Mr. Hausermann moved that the minutes of the February 20, 2025 regular meeting be approved, seconded by Mr. Bainum. Motion carried.

Mr. Hausermann moved on to review the stats of the membership renewals to date provided by Mr. Baird. We have so far received: Active 57%, Affiliate 61% with 7 new memberships, and Associate 25% with one new membership.

Mr. Hausermann then moved on to discuss the GoDaddy subscription renewals to maintain the CCTA website. The breakdown of the two-year renewals are \$45.98 for the domain name, and \$311.52 for the web hosting, bringing the total to \$357.52. Mr. Hausermann called for a motion to have Mr. Baird pay the bills. Ms. Hinnners moved to pay the bills, seconded by Mr. Hodges. Motion carried.

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Mr. Baird reminded that the minutes for the March 20, 2025 regular meeting and the April 7, 2025 special meeting still needed to be approved. Ms. Hinnners moved that the minutes of the March 20 and April 7 meetings be approved, seconded by Mr. Freeman. Motion carried.

Discussion:

Mr. Hausermann asked yielded the discussion to Mr. Freeman. Mr. Freeman provided some overview of the current ballot initiative regarding the repeal of property taxes in Ohio, and the debate of it on social media. A key question to think of is "Where does the funding come from?" Townships can't do a sales tax, or income tax, etc. He recommended that the CCTA spend some time on this topic, perhaps forming a sub-committee, to focus on other ways to approach it. Residential TIFs, etc. He asked Mr. Becker, who replied no, to whether Union Township has used any Residential TIFs.

Mr. Freeman continued giving more details about the topic of TIFs and what they can't be used to fund, for example TIF funds can't be used to pay for emergency services. He proceeded to give an example related to police budgets where there may be a need to reduce the budget, or infuse other funding, but the biggest chunk is salaries which TIFs can't be used for. He then posited that in other states, very liberal states for example, townships can tax other items. Mr. Freeman then handed the discussion over to Ms. Hinnners.

Ms. Hinnners revisited a quote from Representative Adam Bird "Clermont County is one of the fastest growing counties." She then relayed that one of her biggest concerns is on Zoning, and that there is a senate sub-committee that wants to eliminate township and county zoning, centralizing it to the state level.

Mr. Hausermann shared thoughts on topics from the OTA legislative updates about certain exemptions for mega-projects, and about the house bill looking at taxation on Air BnBs. He then commented that the CCTA needs to take a vote of the membership if we want to create these sub-committees. Discussion followed among the members on the method and speed of communication, and wanting to push more that our state representatives pay attention. Mr. Freeman reminded the group again about the 9 bills discussed at the April 7 meeting.

The food arrived so meeting was suspended at 7:05 PM, with the discussion resuming at 7:29 PM.

Ms. Hinnners made a motion to form the sub-committees. Mr. Hausermann asked if the intent is that the sub-committees represent the CCTA at the legislature. Ms. Hinnners replied the intent is not to go that far, but that the sub-committees would meet and discuss issues and bring info back to the CCTA.

Mr. Hausermann noted that active members from 4 or more townships were present and that a quorum exists.

Mr. Freeman moved to form a sub-committee on finance and economic development, seconded by Ms. Hinnners. Motion carried.

Ms. Hinnners moved to create a sub-committee on zoning, seconded by Mr. Bainum. Motion carried.

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Discussion on make-up of the new sub-committees followed. MS. Hinnners plans to send information to the CCTA, active members only, asking those interested in participating in the sub-committees to respond. Mr. Hausermann asked if the CCTA needed to appoint the leaders of the sub-committees. Ms. Hinnners suggested make-up would be 4-5 members and they would choose their own chair.

Mr. Hausermann reviewed the meeting schedule noting that the next meeting isn't until August. Ms. Hinnners commented that waiting is too slow. Debate followed on a tabling motion from Mr. Hodges. Mr. Freeman suggested sending email out to membership. Mr. Hodges clarified that his statement on tabling was a suggestion, not a motion. Debate proceeded on the topic of membership in the new sub-committees. Mr. Bainum provided a strong endorsement for Mr. Sauls.

Ms. Allen asked about the meeting frequency. Ms. Hinnners replied her thought is meetings should be at least once a month, maybe more. It was suggested that initial communication would go through Mr. Baird, then organizational meetings for the sub-committees, then internal communications among the members, with the goal of driving towards an initial report in August.

Ms. Hinnners asked about the speed of sending letters, on letterhead, etc., with a discussion following on the methodology of producing any correspondence.

Mr. Hausermann asked if there was any more discussion on the topic. There being none, Mr. Hausermann announced the next meeting will be in Union Township on August 21st. He asked if there were any other topics anyone would like to discuss. Mr. Bainum asked if anyone else was using the free Amazon tools.

Mr. Hausermann asked if there was anyone else with any news they would like to share from their townships. Mr. Bainum discussed Williamsburg Township's JEDD that was formed in partnership with the Village of Williamsburg and how it has been very beneficial. Further discussion followed among members about the benefits of JEDD. They discussed more details of JEDD, implementation timelines, and how they are structured. JEDD must be created in partnership with a municipality, and TIF and JEDD can be together at the same time.

Discussion moved to the Community Reinvestment Act (CRA) and how it is not the best for townships, but more a way to get funding to developers. Discussion continued around the merits and drawbacks of TIFs.

At approximately 8:00 PM Mr. Hodges moved to adjourn, seconded by Mr. Bainum. Meeting adjourned at 8:01 PM.